

Philipp Hilbert. *Platform Product Manager with a core systems instinct.*

Positioning, ten years of product ownership across regulated platforms, configuration engines, and internal tooling – exactly the stack N26's Product Factory runs on.

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Dear N26 hiring team,

The Product Factory role caught my attention because it is not a generic PM position – it is a specific infrastructure problem: how do you give a rapidly expanding digital bank the ability to launch and modify financial products at speed without accumulating a backlog of bespoke engineering work? That problem has a clear shape, and it is one I have spent meaningful time on.

At Emil Group I joined an InsurTech SaaS platform with the same structural ambition – reduce time-to-market for insurance products from over a year to under a week through centralised configuration engines covering product setup, pricing, underwriting, policy issuance, and document management. I owned the product roadmap for those modules, designed and delivered the Claims Center from concept to production rollout, and rebuilt the delivery process around it: splitting a bloated seventeen-person team into focused Scrum units, reintroducing velocity tracking and structured refinement, and recovering client trust through weekly product workshops. The platform architecture was modular and configuration-driven by design. That is the same architectural philosophy the Product Factory is built on.

My experience with internal tooling and platform product ownership extends across several roles. At Rohde & Schwarz I delivered a central AI data management platform for a multinational government defence programme, owning the full product lifecycle end-to-end – user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps rollout. I reduced deployment times from several days to under forty minutes by introducing ArgoCD-based GitOps. I unblocked infrastructure-level issues in OpenShift that had been open for over a year and delivered them in one week as the sole developer on that feature. At the Federal Employment Agency I served as Deputy IT Security Officer alongside my product role, managed compliance and data lineage governance, and ran ETL and indicator automation via Dagster. Both roles required the kind of backend fluency and cross-functional coordination that the Product Factory posting specifically calls out.

On vendor and third-party integration: I have managed PSP integrations at Kvitt Payment Solutions, CGM API integrations at CLINET, and a complex Shopware catalogue and approval-policy integration at AOK. Each of these required aligning an external roadmap with internal engineering priorities and building compliance guardrails directly into the integration layer rather than bolting them on afterwards.

N26 is building the platform layer that makes the rest of the bank fast. That is unglamorous, load-bearing infrastructure work, and it is the kind of work I find genuinely interesting. I would be glad to discuss how my background maps to the specific challenges your core systems team is working through.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
